

Abhi Nemani

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Government technology leader with 15+ years driving digital transformation, AI strategy, and innovation for cities and states. Served as Chief Data Officer for Los Angeles and Chief Innovation Officer for Sacramento, delivering measurable improvements in service delivery, operational efficiency, and public transparency. Deep expertise in AI governance, open data, and emerging technology—combined with proven ability to navigate complex stakeholder environments, secure legislative support, and build lasting institutional capacity. Co-founded Code for America and helped shape the national civic technology movement, including the creation of 18F and the U.S. Digital Service.

Areas of Expertise

Technology & Innovation	Government Operations	Leadership & Policy
AI Strategy & Governance, Data Analytics, Open Data, Smart City Infrastructure, Digital Service Delivery, IT Modernization	Budgeting & Fiscal Policy, Procurement Reform, Grants Management, Performance Management, Interagency Coordination	Organizational Change, Team Building, Legislative Relations, Stakeholder Engagement, Public-Private Partnerships, Community Engagement

Professional Experience

Senior Vice President, Product Strategy

2023 – 2025

Euna Solutions

Leading GovTech provider serving 3,000+ state, local, and federal agencies in budgeting, grants, procurement, and payments.

- Led product strategy for **\$100M+ software portfolio** serving government agencies nationwide, integrating 10+ acquisitions into unified solutions for public finance and administration.
- Developed and implemented **AI strategy and governance framework** for responsible deployment of generative AI in government contexts—balancing innovation with transparency, security, and accountability.
- Shaped **national policy conversations** on AI in government through partnerships with GFOA, NACo, ICMA, and state associations; regular speaker at government technology conferences.
- Led integration of eCivis and AmpliFund into **Euna Grants**, creating comprehensive solution for federal, state, and local grant management—from application through compliance.
- Built cross-functional teams and developed training programs to help government customers maximize technology adoption and outcomes.

Founder & Managing Director

2017 – 2023

EthosLabs

Advisory firm supporting government agencies, GovTech companies, and public sector investors.

- Advised **state and local governments** on technology strategy, digital transformation, and innovation office development—including engagements with major cities and state agencies.
- Supported **12+ GovTech companies** in developing products and services for government customers, with four achieving successful acquisitions.
- Provided strategic guidance to **Knight Foundation, Arnold Ventures**, and other funders on public sector technology investments and civic innovation initiatives.
- Developed frameworks for **government technology procurement**, helping agencies evaluate vendors and structure contracts for better outcomes.
- Delivered trainings and workshops on **AI in government, digital services, and innovation management** for elected officials, agency leaders, and staff.

Chief Innovation Officer

2016 – 2017

City of Sacramento

California's capital city, population 500,000+, with \$1B+ annual budget.

- Designed and secured **unanimous City Council approval (9–0)** for \$10M Innovation & Growth Fund—the largest municipal innovation fund among mid-sized U.S. cities.
- Established the **Mayor's Office for Innovation and Entrepreneurship (MOFIE)** as a permanent city department, codified by ordinance with dedicated staff and sustainable funding.
- Created **RAILS grant program** (\$1M), supporting 15 organizations across workforce development, STEAM education, and civic technology; delivered from concept to funding in under 4 months with 140+ applications.
- Structured first-of-its-kind **municipal LP investment in 500 Startups**, attracting venture capital presence and positioning Sacramento as an emerging technology hub.
- Convened **Mayor's Tech Council**, bringing together technology executives to advise on city strategy and support implementation of innovation initiatives.

Chief Data Officer

2014 – 2015

City of Los Angeles

Second-largest U.S. city, serving 4M residents with 50,000+ employees and \$10B+ annual budget.

- Led Los Angeles to **#1 national ranking for open data** within one year, publishing 400+ datasets across 20+ departments and earning Platinum certification from the World Council on City Data.
- Built the city's **first data science team** and launched predictive analytics programs in fire risk prevention, workforce hiring, and sanitation—demonstrating how data can improve public safety and operational efficiency.
- Deployed the **Mayor's Performance Dashboard**, enabling data-driven management across 40+ departments with real-time KPIs; saved \$180K annually by replacing vendor tools with open-source infrastructure.
- Founded **GeoHub**, LA's open GIS platform featuring 1,000+ datasets, built in partnership with Esri; cited by White House officials as a national model for spatial data infrastructure.
- Mobilized **10,000+ civic technologists** through hackathons, Code for America Brigade, and community partnerships—building a pipeline of engaged residents contributing to city technology initiatives.

Co-Executive Director

2010 – 2014

Code for America

Previously: Chief of Staff, Director of Strategy & Communications

National nonprofit that launched the civic technology movement and helped establish modern digital government practices.

- Co-founded and scaled organization from 3-person pilot to **60+ staff and \$15M+ annual budget**, expanding partnerships from 3 to 30+ city, state, and county governments.
- Created the **Code for America Fellowship**, placing 75+ technologists in government agencies to build digital services; produced 30+ applications now used by millions of residents nationwide.
- Launched the **first civic technology accelerator**, incubating GovTech startups including OpenCounter (permitting), NextRequest (public records), and Remix (transit planning)—all achieved successful exits.
- Built relationships with **mayors, city managers, and agency heads** across the country, developing replicable models for government technology adoption.
- Published *Beyond Transparency*, the foundational anthology on open data in government; helped catalyze creation of **18F and U.S. Digital Service** at the federal level.
- Advised **20+ cities** on establishing technology and innovation offices, procurement reform, and digital transformation strategy.
- Grew **Code for America Summit** from 50 attendees to 1,000+ government officials, technologists, and civic leaders—establishing the premier convening in the field.

Education

USC Price School of Public Policy

Master of Public Administration

Dean's Award (4.0/4.0)

The Wharton School

Advanced Finance Program

Stanford Graduate School of Business

Executive MBA

Oxford University

Philosophy, Politics & Economics (First Class)

Claremont McKenna College

B.A. Philosophy, Politics & Economics (PPE)

Magna Cum Laude

Board Service & Academic Affiliations

Leading Cities – Board of Directors (2022–Present) – International network of city innovation leaders

Rose Institute of State and Local Government – Research Affiliate (2023–Present)

University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy – Civic Technology Lecturer (2019) – New course for Masters in Computational Analysis and Public Policy (MSCAPP)

Public Interest Technology University Network (PIT-UN) – Selection Committee (2022–Present)

Coding it Forward – Mentor & Speaker (2020–Present) – Fellowship placing technologists in government

SmartCityX – Leadership Circle (2019–Present) – Global smart city accelerator

Newsom for California – Chair, Tech and Innovation Policy Committee (2017–2018)

OpenGov Foundation – Board Member / Vice-Chair (2014–2017)

Recognition & Publications

Awards

Top 10 Chief Data Officers to Watch – Technical.ly

Blair Award for State and Local Government

Partner, Truman National Security Project

GovTech 100 (multiple organizations)

Mentor of the Year – University of Chicago

"2025 Best Budgeting and Planning Tool" - Globee Awards

Writing

Rethinking budgeting: A transformative approach for state and local governments - Route Fifty

Strategic Planning in a Time of Change - Funkhouser & Associates

Beyond Transparency: Open Data and the Future of Civic Innovation – Code for America Press (Editor)

"Dashboards: The Underbelly of the Smart City" – UMKC Law Review

"How Cities Can Compete in the Future of Work" – USC Price School

"Here's What We Need for Civic Tech to Flourish" – Apolitical

Lectures & Presentations

TEDxSacramento: "Hack of the Century: Cities" - TEDxSacramento

Texas Association of State Systems: "How the Smart City Failed"

Federal Communications Summit: "Government is What We Do Together"

NAGW: "Let's Move Beyond Open Data Portals"

World Bank: How Cities Share Technology

University of Chicago: Introduction to Civic Technology